Supplementary Information

Delayed Distributed Coarsening in an Exactly Reversible Signed-Charge-Conserving Block Cellular Automaton

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Supplement to the companion paper, version 0.2.6, 3 September 2026. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.22270456
Working paper, not peer reviewed.
Companion to *Zero Without Stasis* v1.278, DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21966374.

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1. Scope and evidence status

This Supplement documents the frozen model, the provenance of the selected rule, exact audits, confirmatory measurements, mechanism constraints, and the failure of the later v0.3.2 history-erasure endpoint. It was rebuilt from compact stored evidence without new simulation. The original v0.3.2 report and its figures are preserved as immutable historical records; the additive erratum and corrected derivative govern current interpretation.

Four evidence classes are kept distinct:

1. **Discovery:** a tiny smoke search and its exploratory winner run.
2. **Confirmation:** frozen-rule repeats and the large exact reversal.
3. **Mechanism constraints:** density, finite-size, geometry, arrangement, matched-sibling, and ablation comparisons.
4. **Classifier diagnostics:** v0.3.2 results that diagnose a failed endpoint rather than answer the intended causal question.

2. Automaton definition

2.1 Alphabet and observables

The four cell states are empty (0), positive excitation (+), negative excitation (−), and bound-neutral excitation (b). For a lattice state x,

$$Q(x) = N_+(x) - N_-(x), \tag{1}$$

$$M(x) = N_+(x) + N_-(x) + N_{\mathrm{b}}(x). \tag{2}$$

Q is a signed additive charge. M counts non-empty cells and is called occupancy or material in the software. The selected rule conserves Q in every local block update but not M. All principal worlds were initialized in the global $Q = 0$ sector. The phrase "$Q = 0$ sector" must not be read as "the rule conserves the value zero only", "Q and M both vanish", or "the world is empty".

2.2 Block code and phase schedule

On a periodic $H \times W$ lattice with even dimensions, alternating 2×2 Margolus partitions cover the lattice. Each four-cell block is packed in base four to an integer in $[0, 255]$. A permutation f of those 256 codes supplies the forward update; f^{-1} supplies the inverse. The checkerboard phase is part of the dynamical state. Exact reversal applies the inverse table while stepping phases in reverse order.

The frozen table is stored in `extensions/reversible_null_phase/rules/winner_d1fe99.json`. SHA-256 of the raw 256 unsigned-byte table, not the JSON serialization, is

`d1fe99b5735d8e9be032347de2727dc5c52a7848df200ca26f67f28c8c1bc41c`.

The rule is a permutation; all 256 outputs are unique. Exhaustive enumeration verifies $Q(f(b)) = Q(b)$ for every block state b. The same enumeration finds block states for which $M(f(b)) \neq M(b)$.

The block code uses base-four order top-left, top-right, bottom-left, bottom-right,

$$c = s_{\mathrm{TL}} + 4s_{\mathrm{TR}} + 16s_{\mathrm{BL}} + 64s_{\mathrm{BR}}. \tag{3}$$

The construction starts from clockwise block rotation and exchanges 12 reversible output pairs; consequently, 24 of 256 inputs differ from the rotation scaffold. Two entries used in the main-text worked diagram are exact table values. Entry $f(1) = 4$ maps $(+, 0; 0, 0)$ to $(0, +; 0, 0)$ and preserves $(Q, M) = (+1, 1)$. Entry $f(130) = 154$ maps $(-, 0; 0, -)$ to $(-, -; +, -)$ and changes (Q, M) from $(-2, 2)$ to $(-2, 4)$: one positive and one negative excitation are added as a balanced pair. The inverse permutation maps code 154 back to code 130. These examples illustrate transport and reaction channels; they are not a claim that either lookup alone is sufficient for the macroscopic behaviour.

3. Rule discovery and selection accounting

3.1 What was searched

The historical discovery metadata records construction family `reactive_rotation`, elite source `g0000_reactive12`, final rank zero, 12 swaps, 14 unique rules evaluated, and 16 replicate rule evaluations. The search run was a smoke-scale campaign. It was not a representative sample of the enormous permutation space (metadata reports a theoretical base-10 rule-space logarithm of approximately 317.961), and the selected rule must be described as search-selected.

3.2 Declared score

For each candidate, the software averaged activity, reaction density, state entropy, block entropy, spatial mutual information, temporal mutual information, recurrence, and perturbation distance over sampled phases and measured repeated 4×4 patches. A weighted sum rewarded broad intermediate target bands:

Term	Weight
Activity	0.14
Reaction density	0.11
State entropy	0.11
Block entropy	0.11
Spatial mutual information	0.14
Temporal mutual information	0.14
Recurrence	0.10
Perturbation distance	0.09
Patch repetition	0.06

A sigmoid gate penalized insufficient activity and reaction, and failure of charge preservation assigned a sentinel score. The exact bands and softness parameters are in `src/zws_nullity_lab/metrics.py`. The search therefore selected for lively, structured, nontrivial dynamics. It did not select on large-lattice reversal, strong-domain first passage, density dependence, finite-size scaling, event morphology, prepared geometry, double conservation, reaction-pair ablation, prevalence, or history-erasure diagnostics.

3.3 Evidence matrix

Stage	Frozen object	Principal output	Valid inference
Discovery	small reactive-rotation search	selected winner from 14 unique candidates / 16 replicate evaluations	provenance only; selected behaviour
Confirmation	winner, large torus, inverse schedule	4096^2, 65,536 forward phases, zero mismatches after inversion	exact implementation-level coexistence of reversal and structure
Repeat runs	winner, four localized-patch seeds	transient scale peak 72.66–136.11×	reproducible large finite-time transient
Composition	frozen state summaries	occupancy 0.572989; normalized entropy 0.946343	local state diversity survives macrostructure
Density	seven initial occupancies	event fraction and survival shift strongly with density	finite-time density dependence
Morphology	event-centred windows	67 distributed, 24 unresolved, 0 localized	no support for simple localized-front story
Prepared geometry	droplet, slab and homogeneous controls	0/48 vs 19/24 events by 262,144 phases	relative-growth counts only; different initial baselines, while shapes persist
Exact-$Q{+}M$ sibling	reactive matched sibling	0/16 vs winner 10/16	nearby double-conservation rule does not reproduce regime

Stage	Frozen object	Principal output	Valid inference
Ablations	twelve single-pair removals	0–7/16 versus winner 10/16	multiple reaction channels contribute
Prevalence	256 generator draws	19/256, Wilson 95% 4.8026–11.3001%	nonunique within sampled generator only
History erasure v0.3.2	shuffled branches + old endpoint	classifier triggered on shuffled noise	endpoint failure; no causal conclusion

4. Exact reversal and composition

The large audit used a 4096×4096 periodic lattice (16,777,216 cells) with a populated central random patch, not a whole-world homogeneous start. The square patch spans 45% of each dimension; its target internal proportions are 12% positive, 12% negative and 8% bound-neutral, and the exterior is empty. After 65,536 forward block phases, the run reversed the phase schedule and applied the inverse permutation. The final recovered state was identical to the initial state at every cell. Global signed charge remained $Q = 0$. Occupancy M changed during the trajectory, as permitted by the rule.

The four 4096×4096 localized-patch confirmation runs supplied the reported final dense-interior median occupancy 0.572989, positive fraction 0.192542, negative fraction 0.192535, and bound-neutral fraction 0.187912. Normalized four-state entropy was 0.946343. Those four localized-patch confirmatory winner runs reached transient domain-scale maxima of 72.66–136.11 times their initial scale (median 98.4459); the final stored scales were 15.77–16.33 times initial (median 16.1118). This nonmonotonicity is why the paper says "coarsening-like organisation" rather than monotonic phase ordering.

5. Endpoint definitions and initial-condition provenance

5.1 Distinct initial-condition families

The large reversal and the four 4096^2 growth/composition confirmations use the localized-patch family above. Whole-torus homogeneous-random studies are separate: the principal density map and later first-passage study use 1024^2 lattices, with smaller 512^2 comparisons and limited 2048^2 checks in the recorded campaigns. In the homogeneous density family, an exact inventory with occupied proportions 3/8 positive, 3/8 negative and 2/8 bound-neutral is shuffled over the entire torus. For target occupancy ρ and N sites, the documented rounding is $u = \lfloor \rho N/8 + 1/2 \rfloor$, giving counts $(N - 8u, 3u, 3u, 2u)$. These ensemble constructions must not be pooled as the same initial condition.

5.2 The implemented v0.3/v0.3.1 endpoint

Let $a_i(t_j)$ be the areas of finite (non-wrapping) empty components returned by the frozen campaign's four-neighbour toroidal component code. The characteristic scale is the equivalent-circle radius of the area-weighted component area,

$$L_j = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_i a_i(t_j)^2}{\pi \sum_i a_i(t_j)}}. \tag{4}$$

When no finite empty component exists, $L_j = 0$. "Finite" here excludes winding components; it does not mean that other components contain infinitely many sites on the finite torus. Historical topology implementations and the later topology correction remain versioned; this description does not retrospectively recompute any campaign.

Set $D = \max(L_0, 1)$ and $r_j = L_j/D$. For a prefix through sample k, choose $j^* = \min \arg\max_{0 \le j \le k} r_j$ and let f_j be the largest finite empty component's fraction of all sites. The exact implemented predicate is

$$C_k = \mathbf{1}[r_{j^*} \ge 4 \ \wedge \ r_k \ge 2 \ \wedge \ f_{j^*} \ge 0.001 \ \wedge \ (\forall j \le k : Q_j = Q_0)]. \tag{5}$$

At least two snapshots are required. The largest-component fraction is evaluated at the *first peak-scale sample*, not necessarily at its own separate maximum. No Fourier, low-k, entropy or mutual-information threshold enters C_k. Those diagnostics are recorded independently. The paper therefore does not describe the endpoint as a joint spectral-and-geometrical test.

For v0.3.1, sampled phases are spaced by 2,048. T_{hit} is the earliest sample with $C_k = 1$. $T_{\text{persistent}}$ is the earliest start of three consecutive true prefix flags, which can follow an earlier isolated hit. No event time is interpolated between observations; an absent event is right-censored at the trajectory's actual follow-up horizon. The implementation sources are `metrics.py:StrongDomainCriterion` and `nucleation.py:first_passage_from_flags`, at the computational release identified in the provenance note.

5.3 Earlier frozen endpoints are not identical

The original 2026-08-25 confirmation required final coarse-density dispersion at least 8, at least twofold final empty-domain scale, a positive fitted late-half scale slope and exact charge preservation. Its strict sustained-coarsening result failed at the larger scale; the reproduced transient morphology was reported separately.

The later v0.1 homogeneous-density map used peak/final scale ratios of at least 4/2 and a peak largest finite-empty area of at least $\max(64, 16\max(A_0, 1))$, where A_0 is the initial largest finite-empty area, with $Q = 0$ at every saved phase. Its *separate* low-k flag required radial shells $k = 1, \ldots, 4$ to have peak/final mean-power ratios of at least 4/2 and peak spectral-fraction ratio at least 2. The v0.3 family instead uses the 0.001 lattice-fraction condition above, as explicitly stated in the v0.3.1 preregistration. Thus the earlier approximately 27.5% estimate is an operational result of that earlier campaign, not a directly interchangeable critical-density estimate. Within each unchanged endpoint, different time horizons can be compared without making this substitution.

5.4 Different sources for the main image panels

The main reversal figure uses localized discovery seed 260824 and an organised intermediate panel at phase 20,480. Its recovered panel displays the phase-zero state whose exact recovery was established by the 65,536-phase inverse audit. The main micro/macro figure instead uses untouched homogeneous 1024^2 source `3cde465f2d2883dd5af4`, initial density 0.20, seed 6203 and phase 311,296. Its nested 64^2 crop has counts $(1359, 899, 947, 891)$ and normalized single-site entropy 0.987741. This image is distinct from the four localized confirmation runs' dense-interior statistic 0.946343. The v0.3.2 causal-endpoint failure does not invalidate a direct image of the untouched source.

Table 2: Frozen finite-ensemble first-passage summary.

Initial occupancy	Events / 12	KM median (phases)	Follow-up horizon (phases)
0.16	0	not reached	262,144
0.18	8	495,616	524,288
0.20	12	321,536	262,144 / 524,288[a]
0.22	12	206,848	262,144
0.24	12	108,544	262,144
0.25	12	83,968	262,144
0.26	12	65,536	262,144

Homogeneous 1024^2 worlds; Kaplan–Meier median is the first sample at which the estimated survival is at most 1/2, not the median of observed events alone. [a] At occupancy 0.20, two already-transformed runs retained their 262,144-phase record and ten censored trajectories continued to 524,288. Four of the 0.18 trajectories remained right-censored. Recorded horizons, not an imputed common duration, are shown.

6. Density and first passage

At 0.18, the extended follow-up changed the interpretation of the shorter campaign: events continued to appear late, so a short-horizon fixed threshold could not be retained. Survival curves preserve censoring. The paper does not extrapolate an infinite-time event probability or claim a critical density. Finite-size and area-scaling analyses did not support the simple local-Poisson expectation tested, but the available sizes do not establish an alternative asymptotic law.

Event-centred morphology labels were B/distributed for 67 events, E/unresolved for 24, and A/localized for none. The label is a measured classifier under frozen windows, not an ontological statement about every possible initiation process.

7. Arrangement and prepared-shape controls

Prepared droplets and slabs retained or enlarged their imposed geometry but produced zero strong-domain endpoint crossings across 48 trials by 262,144 phases. Matched homogeneous starts produced 19 crossings in 24 trials. These are outcomes of a *relative-growth* assay: the denominator is each trajectory's own initial finite-empty-domain scale. A prepared macroscopic shape is not on the same baseline as random soup. Accordingly, 0/48 is not evidence that seeded organisation failed to form or persist, and this contrast alone does not establish a basin barrier, history inhibition or failure of all compact seeds. The direct measurements of retained geometry remain valid, separately from the endpoint counts.

Earlier arrangement comparisons and phase controls are retained in the experiment reports. Their role is to constrain trivial initialization artifacts, not to establish a thermodynamic ensemble.

8. Double conservation and reaction-pair ablations

The exact-$Q{+}M$ sibling is a distinct permutation whose every local block update preserves both signed charge and occupancy. It was chosen as the closest tested reactive sibling rather than as a universal representative of double-conserving automata. Mean reaction density remained 0.01160, close to the winner's 0.01234, so its negative endpoint is not explained by a dead rule. In the focused comparison the winner produced 8/8 strong-domain outcomes and the sibling

0/8. In the pooled balanced profile the winner produced 10/16, the sibling 0/16, and pure rotation 0/16.

Table 3: Pooled matched controls and ablations.

Condition	Strong-domain passes	Trials	Interpretation at tested protocol
Frozen winner (exact Q)	10	16	reference
Reactive exact-Q+M sibling	0	16	active, no winner regime
Pure rotation	0	16	transport-only negative control
Ablations 01, 11	7 each	16 each	partial retention
Ablation 05	6	16	partial retention
Ablations 08, 09	3 each	16 each	strong attenuation
Ablation 06	2	16	strong attenuation
Ablations 00, 02, 03, 04, 07, 10	0 each	16 each	suppression

The six zero-pass ablations and the graded intermediate responses support a cooperative reaction architecture. They do not identify a unique minimal causal set because only single-pair removals were tested and finite-horizon zeroes are not impossibility theorems.

9. Prevalence screen

The generator screen counted 19 strong-domain rules among 256 independent charge-preserving candidates, a sample proportion of 0.074219 and Wilson 95% confidence interval 0.048026–0.113001. This estimate pertains to the specified generator and protocol. It does not measure the fraction of all local permutations, all charge-preserving permutations, or all rule-construction families. The selected winner remains selected evidence.

10. v0.3.2 classifier failure and correction

10.1 Intended intervention

The v0.3.2 campaign branched deterministic trajectories at frozen source states. Global and hierarchical shuffles preserved each single-site state count, hence Q, M, and single-site entropy, and retained the partition phase. The intervention removed spatial arrangement while leaving the subsequent rule deterministic. Every one of 72 altered-branch intervention audits passed. The topology-fixed run is the only valid raw basis; the earlier topology-bug run is excluded.

The intended primary contrast was first passage to the existing strong-domain endpoint after shuffling versus an untouched continuation. This would have been informative only if the endpoint discriminated the organised source geometry from the shuffled geometry.

10.2 Immediate state audit

It did not. In Branch A primary global shuffles, mean low-wave-number power fell from 5,544.267654 to 43.719036: 99.211455% of the source value was removed. Interface density rose from 0.364832 to 0.455946, anisotropy fell from 0.549951 to 0.159870, and nearest-neighbour mutual information fell from 0.0208694 to approximately 4.05×10^{-6}. The intervention therefore did erase measured organisation.

In all 20 Branch-B global shuffles, mean low-wave-number power fell from 7,246.310873 to 45.649658. Yet 9 of the 16 primary Branch-B replicates were assigned $R_{\mathrm{hit}} = 0$, 14/16 hit by

4,096 phases, 15/16 by 6,144 phases, and the remaining row hit at 20,480 phases. The post-shuffle long-wave mean was only 729.492 at 8,192 phases and 1,127.719 at 16,384 phases, still far below the natural source mean. The classifier was therefore responding before long-wave structure had recovered.

Table 4: Compact audit establishing endpoint failure.

Quantity	Natural source states	Globally shuffled branch states
Long-wave spectral power, Branch A primary	5,544.27 (mean)	43.72 immediately after shuffle
Long-wave power removed	–	99.21%
Nearest-neighbour mutual information	organised source	approximately 4.05×10^{-6} after shuffle
Strong-domain hit at elapsed zero	pre-hit source by branch design	9/16 Branch B primary replicates
Strong-domain hit by 4,096 phases	–	14/16 Branch B primary replicates
Untouched Branch-A residual record	$R_{\text{hit}} = -28,672$, observed=false	$R_{\text{persistent}} = 83,968$

The endpoint's connected-empty-cluster terms can be triggered by random high-occupancy geometry even when long-wave organisation has been destroyed. Therefore the v0.3.2 first-passage comparison is not a valid assay of preserved causal spatial memory.

One exact elapsed-zero shuffled state had occupancy 0.409520, histogram (619,163; 145,846; 145,846; 137,721), $Q = 0$, low-wave fraction 0.000243482, and nearest-neighbour mutual information approximately 5.57×10^{-6}, but nevertheless met the strong-domain endpoint. The finite empty-cluster scale was 157.657 and the largest finite empty component occupied 0.191215 of the lattice. Random high-occupancy geometry can thus create large connected empty components without the organised source's long-wave structure.

The compact residual-time record also contains a secondary caveat: for source `49461bd54e39582ab4fb`, density 0.20, seed 6202, `untouched_R_hit` is $-28,672$ while `untouched_hit_observed` is false; its persistent residual is 83,968. A negative residual cannot be read as a valid positive post-intervention first-hit time. These historical fields are preserved, not repaired into a new event time. All 72 altered branches terminated as `post_persistent_capture_complete`; maximum elapsed coverage was exactly $R_{\text{persistent}} + 16,384$. The campaign ran as designed. The scientific failure is classifier validity for this intervention, not execution completeness.

10.3 What is withdrawn and what remains usable

Withdrawn: claims that the shuffled branches showed immediate recovery of genuine macroscopic organisation; that hidden multiscale precursor memory was thereby necessary; that erasing history inhibited or accelerated the transition; or that the result established a causal spatial-memory mechanism.

Retained: exact intervention preservation audits; direct evidence that shuffling erased long-wave structure, local mutual information, and anisotropy; deterministic post-intervention trajectories; recovery curves as descriptive dynamics; and the methodological lesson that a connected-cluster endpoint must be revalidated under the intervention's null distribution. The connected-

empty-cluster explanation is a diagnostic supported by the observed state geometry, not a proof of equilibrium percolation.



Figure 1: Historical v0.3.2 branch images, reclassified as diagnostics. Measured: source, shuffled, and post-shuffle states. Warranted inference: the shuffle visibly destroys large-scale organisation while preserving inventory. Limitation: the old endpoint can label the fine-grained shuffled geometry as already strong-domain; this figure is not evidence of causal memory or recovery speed.

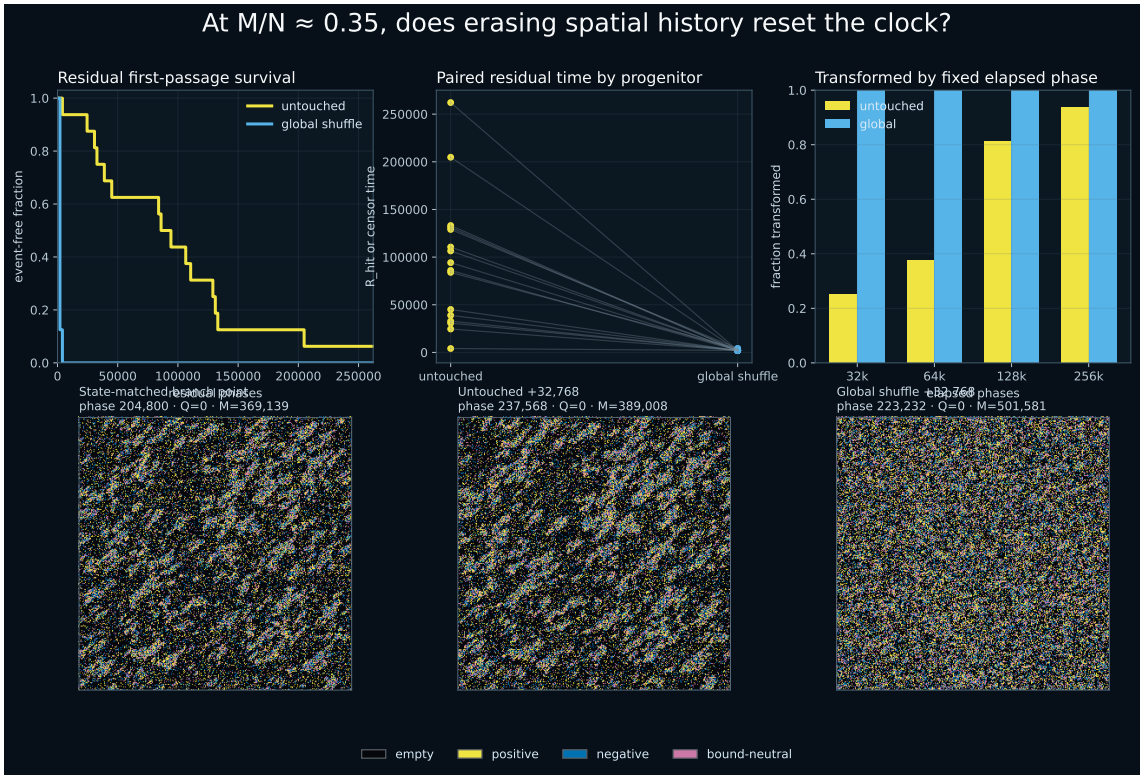


Figure 2: Historical fixed-occupancy intervention figure, diagnostic use only. Measured: identical single-site inventory under changed arrangement. Warranted inference: composition alone does not preserve the source images' measured organisation. Limitation: first passage to the confounded endpoint cannot compare causal history.

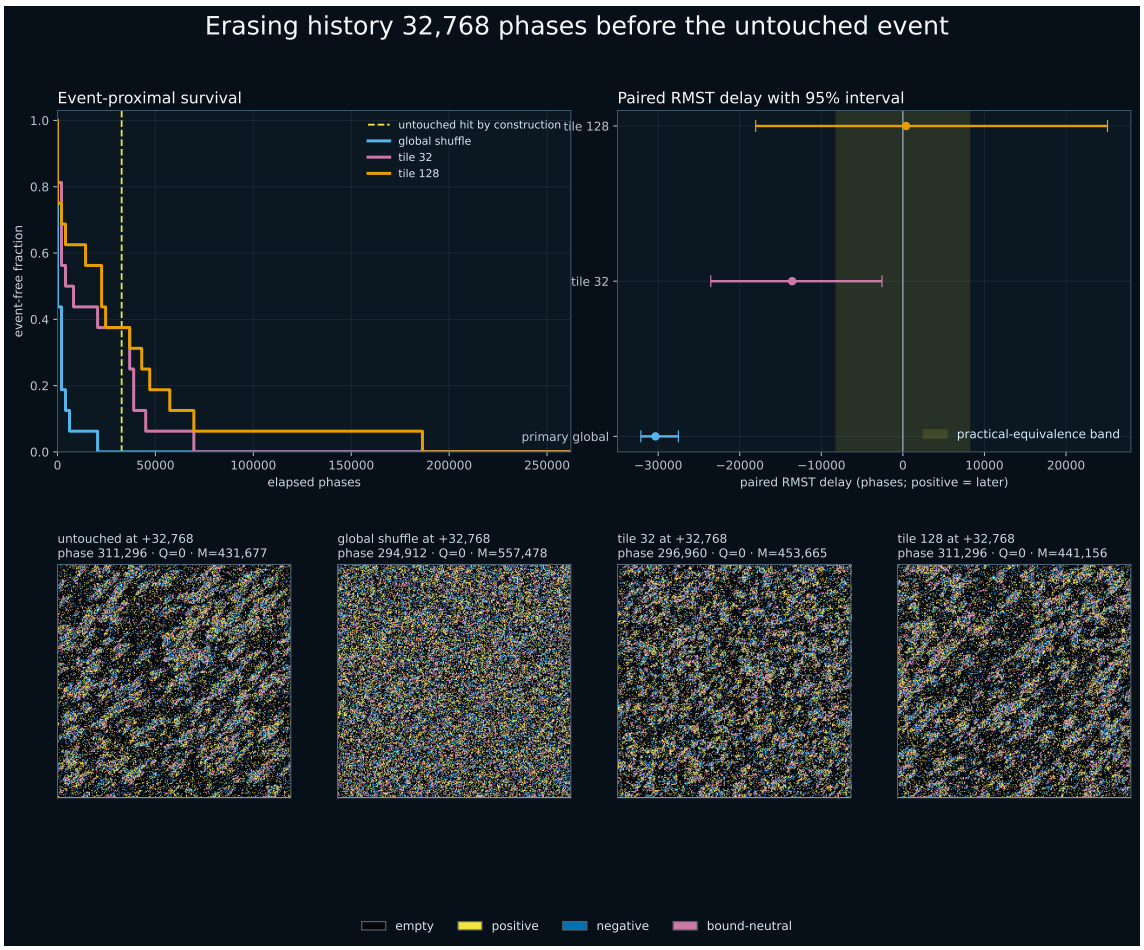


Figure 3: Historical event-proximal branches, diagnostic use only. Measured: intervention timing and stored trajectories. Warranted inference: the governed branch construction executed reproducibly. Limitation: proximity to the old endpoint does not validate that endpoint under shuffled null geometry.

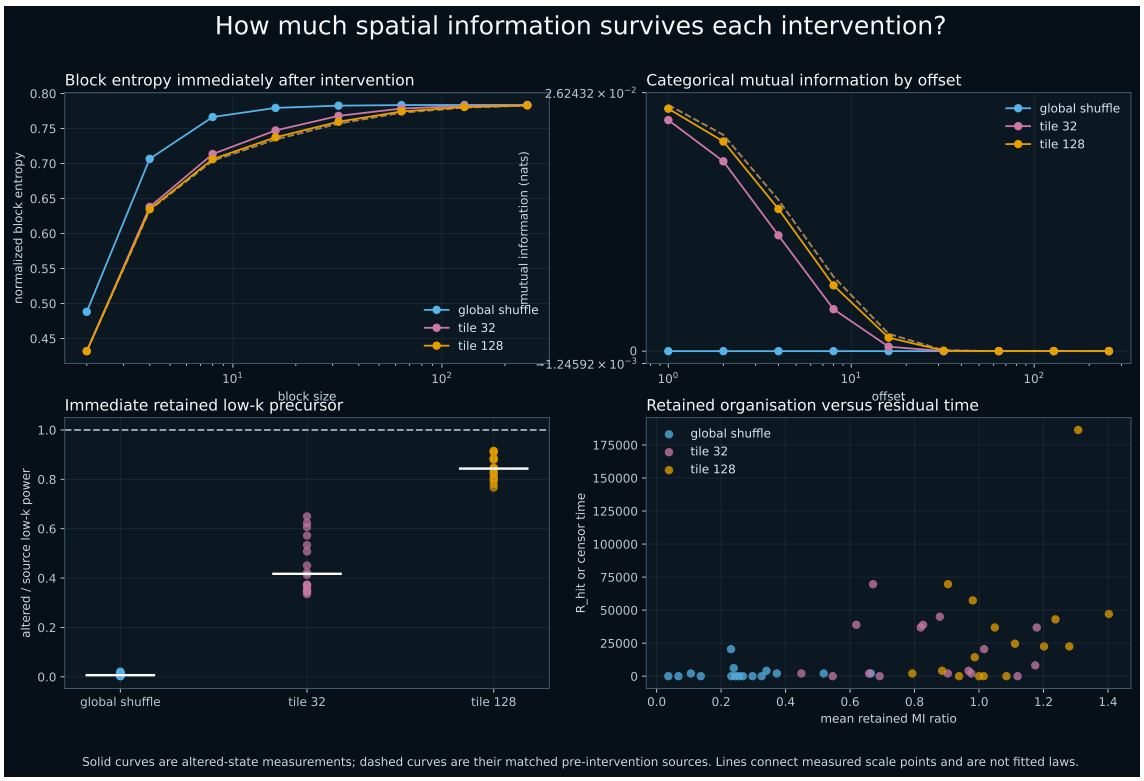


Figure 4: Historical hierarchical-shuffle figure, diagnostic use only. Measured: scale-dependent arrangement perturbations and post-intervention observables. Warranted inference: the stored series can describe structural recovery by direct metrics. Limitation: it cannot support the withdrawn history-inhibition headline through the old first-passage classifier.

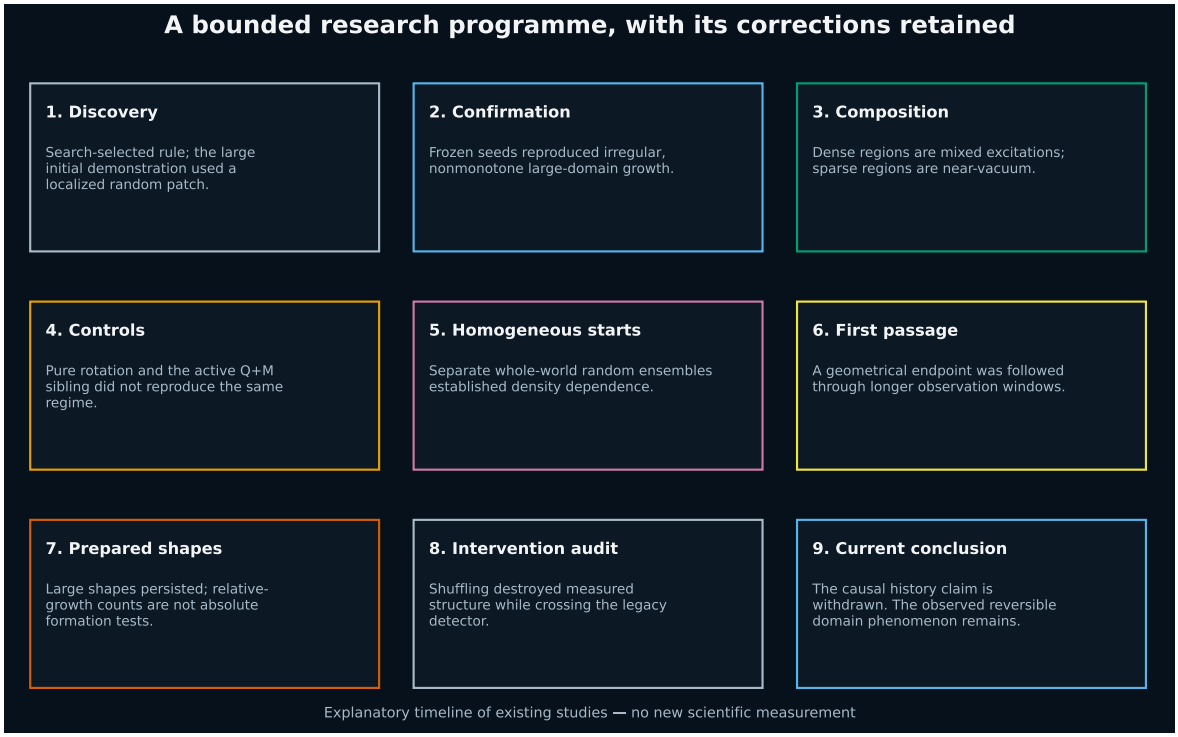


Figure 5: Corrected research timeline. This explanatory ledger distinguishes robust discovery and confirmation from mechanism constraints and ends with the v0.3.2 classifier correction. It is not an additional measurement.

11. Prior-art positioning

Reversible block automata and conservative logic are foundational precedents [1–3]. Lattice gases provide exact local collision and transport frameworks [4–7], and reversible lattice-gas work directly addresses macroscopic irreversibility under microscopically reversible dynamics [8]. Q2R models provide reversible conservative statistical dynamics [9–11]; reversible aggregation provides an especially close visual and mechanistic neighbour [12]. Reversible number-conserving automata and partitioned constructions further narrow the architectural context [13, 14]. Two-species reversible automata with vacancies, reactions and multiple local charges are close modern neighbours [15, 16]; reactive lattice-gas waves and Turing patterns provide a nonreversible pattern-forming comparison [17]. The full query log, DOI audit, comparison matrix, v0.2.3 correction audit, and bounded stopping rule are in `paper/prior_art`.

The residual contribution is the combination, not any isolated ingredient: an exact four-state signed invariant with variable occupancy; delayed distributed coarsening-like organisation; exact large-lattice reversal; density and waiting-time characterisation; and a hierarchy of geometry, double-conservation, and reaction controls. The review does not claim exhaustive priority.

12. Reproducibility, hashes, and archive policy

Compact source tables, reports, figures, figure manifests, rule files, environment records, and SHA-256 sidecars are committed. Large raw trajectories and checkpoints are intentionally excluded from Git and named by external path and hash in the release manifests. Public figures have PDF, PNG, and SVG forms. Manuscript and Supplement PDFs are built from the tracked TeX sources.

Independent parity oracle. The frozen rule and the Margolus update were re-implemented in Eshkol [18] (version 1.3.4-evolve), a Scheme-based language compiled to native code via LLVM. The Python package generates a self-contained Eshkol program that re-runs the exhaustive 256-entry audit (output range, permutation uniqueness, exact local charge) and replays a 16×16 exact-inventory torus (initial occupancy 0.28, seed 303) for 256 steps; the Python simulator's expected final lattice is stored beside the source and every cell is compared. The recorded run reports `AUDIT_OK`, zero mismatched cells, and exact agreement in $Q = 0$ and $M = 97$. The generated program, the expected lattice and the recorded result ship in the release under `extensions/reversible_null_phase/eshkol/`.

The historical v0.3.2 source report, completion record, manifests, figures, and raw results are not overwritten. The additive files `ERRATUM_HISTORY_ERASURE_CLASSIFIER.md` and `corrected_HISTORY_ERASURE_REPORT_20260831.md` state the current interpretation. The corrected companion archive contains a withdrawal notice at its top level.

The v0.2.1 methods and provenance corrections, v0.2.2 disclosure changes, and v0.2.3 worked-rule and literature-audit additions are retained in this v0.2.6 revision. No new scientific simulation or change to numerical results was made in these publication passes. Version 0.2.4 replaces the superseded opening composite with direct embedding of the four hash-verified archived source-panel PNGs; the simulation source and archived evidence remain those of the preserved computational release. The archived release is deposited at Zenodo, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22270456; version 0.2.5 typesets the paper in the house style of *Zero Without Stasis* and prints that DOI, changing presentation and metadata only; version 0.2.6 adds the citation of Eshkol, the language of the independent parity oracle [18].

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